

Restoration: Restoration of normal network operations is the final goal of any security violation response. Define in the security policy how you conduct, secure, and make available normal backups. As each system has its own means and procedures for backing up, the security policy should act as a meta-policy, detailing for each system the security conditions that require restoration from backup. If approval is required before restoration can be done, include the process for obtaining approval as well.

Review: The review process is the final effort in creating and maintaining a security policy. There are three things you'll need to review: policy, posture, and practice. The security policy should be a living document that adapts to an ever-changing environment. Reviewing the existing policy against known Best Practices keeps the network up to date. Also, check the CERT Web site (<http://www.cert.org>) for useful tips, practices, security improvements, and alerts that can be incorporated into your security policy.

You should also review the network's posture in comparison with the desired security posture. An outside firm that specialises in security can attempt to penetrate the network and test not only the posture of the network, but the security response of your organisation as well. For high-availability networks, it's recommended to conduct such a test annually.

Finally, practice is defined as a drill or test of the support staff to insure that they have a clear understanding of what to do during a security violation. Often, this drill is unannounced by management and done in conjunction with the network posture test. This review identifies gaps in procedures and training of personnel so that corrective action can be taken.

IV. The Need For Secure Operating Systems

Source: "The Inevitability of Failure: The Flawed Assumption of Security in Modern Computing Environments"
available at
<http://jya.com/paperF1.htm>